

Punctuation and Capitalization

Capitalization

1) The first letter of a sentence needs to be capitalized.

Example: **The** sun rises in the east.

2) Proper nouns (names of specific people, places, objects etc.) need to be capitalized.

Example: **Emily** went to **Paris** for vacation.

3) Titles and headings are always capitalized.

Example: I love the movie **Gulliver's Travels**.

4) Days of week, months and holidays are capitalized.

Example: a) She will visit us on **Monday**.

b) Today is **International Mother Language Day**.

c) We had a party last **July** at the house.

[Seasons do not need to be capitalized – My favorite season is **winter**.]

5) Names of specific historical events and periods are capitalized.

Example: a) **The Great Depression** is an important economic event in American History.

b) **The Renaissance Era** was known for its cultural advancements.

6) Names of continents, countries, cities, rivers, mountains are to be capitalized.

Example: **The Nile River** flows through **Egypt**.

7) The names of religions, holy books need to be capitalized.

Example: She reads the **Quran** every night.

8) Each letter in an acronym is capitalized.

Example: **NASA** (National Aeronautics and Space Administration)

9) Brand names are always capitalized.

Example: My favorite bottled water is **Kinley**.

10) Do Not capitalize after a colon.

Example: Paula has one hobby: **jumping jacks**.

(But if it is a proper noun, Capitalize it => Suzi's favorite place to go on vacation: **New York**.)

Punctuation

Comma (,):

1) Used is a series of three or more information.

Example: Jim swims, golfs, and fishes in the summer.

2) Used to separate two main clauses joined conjunction like – by, and, but, for, nor, yet, or, so etc.

Example: Sima took a day off, and she is planning on resting.

3) Used between cities and states. It is also used after states, if the state is mentioned in the middle of the sentence.

Example: a) Dave lives in Denver, Colorado.

b) Before moving Denver, Colorado, Dave lived in Buffalo, New York.

4) Used between dates and years. It is also used after year, if the year is mentioned in the middle of the sentence.

Example: a) We will graduate on June 6, 2024.

b) It wasn't until March 15, 2023, that Harry got his license.

5) Used after sentences beginning with in spite of, despite, because, if, since, while etc.

Example: a) Because of the traffic jam, we were late to class.

b) If it doesn't rain this weekend, we'll go on a trip.

6) Used before or after calling someone by name.

Example: a) Freya, are you home?

b) Have you finished the project, Sam?

7) Used with appositives. Appositive means a noun phrase that comes after another noun phrase to provide extra information.

Example: Samantha, my elder sister, is having a baby.

8) Use to answer yes or no to a question.

Example: Yes, I like drinking tea.

9) Use in writing address.

Example: Please send this letter to 32/A, Gulshan, Dhaka 1212.

10) Used before quoting someone's words.

Example: Madeline said, “My sister is studying is Harvard”.

11) Used after titles such as M.A., Ph.D., Sr., Jr. etc.

Example: a) Paxton Thomas, Jr., not his father is the president of the company.

b) Joyce Byard, Ph.D., is the director of the English Language Institute.

Period (.):

1) Used at the end of a sentence.

Example: My favorite game is football.

2) Used after abbreviations like Dr. (doctor), St. (street), oz. (ounce), a.m., p.m., Mr. (mister) etc.

Example: I went to Dr. Gomez for a checkup.

3) Used to separate dollars and cents in prices.

Example: A stick of butter costs \$5.10.

4) Used while writing decimals and percentages.

Example: Today her business profit was 78.5%

5) A period is not needed if a sentence ends with a title or abbreviation that requires a period.

Example: My new title is Dr. Morgan Stewart, Ph.D.

Question Mark (?):

1) Used at the end of an interrogative sentence.

Example: Do you know when the train will arrive?

Exclamation Point (!):

1) Used at the end of a statement that expresses a strong point or surprise.

Example: Jessie told me that you're having a baby!

Quotation Mark (" "):

1) Used when quoting someone's exact words. Periods and Commas always come inside the quote marks. If the question marks and exclamation points are part of the quoted sentence, they also go inside the quotation mark.

Example: **a)** Phil said, “The American Revolution began in April, 1775.”

b) “All of us will attend the wedding,” said the Bride’s best friend.

c) Tim yelled, “The building is on fire! Get out!”

Colon (:):

1) Used between hours and minutes of time expressions.

Example: The train is due at 6:45 a.m.

2) Used before mentioning a list of items, people, places etc.

Example: Only 3 students attended the class: Sean, Nick, and Toby.

Semicolon (;):

1) Used when joining two complete, related sentences not connected by - but, and, or, yet etc.

Example: Billy received the highest grade; he got a scholarship to study at Oxford.

2) Used before conjunctive adverbs (adverbs that connect the ideas of two sentences – otherwise, therefore, nevertheless, however etc.). The semicolon sits before the adverb and comma is used after the adverb.

Example: Sid could not pay his landlord; therefore, he got evicted.

- 3) Used after parenthetical expression (extra information added to a sentence – in fact, on the other hand, for example etc.)

Example: Sadie never eats spinach; in fact, she hates it.

Apostrophe ('):

- 1) Used to form contractions.

Example: a) They weren't (were not) at the park.

b) I'm (I am) going to help you.

- 2) Use to show possession.

Example: a) Richie's cat went missing yesterday.

b) Are you the teacher's pet?

- 3) Used to indicate missing letters and numbers.

Example: a) The '90s songs are very different from this generation.

b) We did the project in a li'l different way.